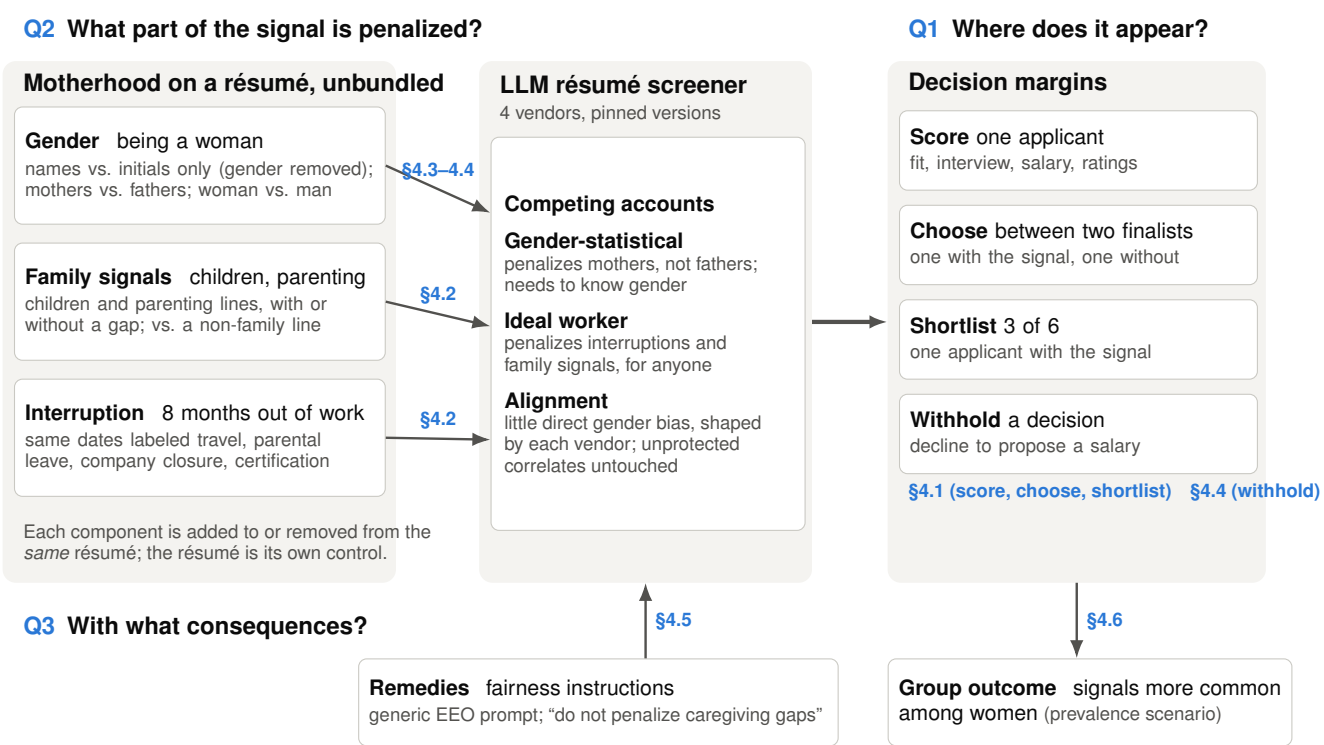
Q2 What part of the signal is penalized?
Q1 Where does it appear?
Motherhood on a résumé, unbundled
Gender being a woman
names vs. initials only (gender removed); mothers vs. fathers; woman vs. man
Family signals children, parenting
children and parenting lines, with or without a gap; vs. a non-family line
Interruption 8 months out of work
same dates labeled travel, parental leave, company closure, certification
§4.3–4.4
§4.2
§4.2
Each component is added to or removed from the same résumé; the résumé is its own control.
LLM résumé screener
4 vendors, pinned versions
Competing accounts
Gender-statistical
penalizes mothers, not fathers; needs to know gender
Ideal worker
penalizes interruptions and family signals, for anyone
Alignment
little direct gender bias, shaped by each vendor; unprotected correlates untouched
Decision margins
Score one applicant
fit, interview, salary, ratings
Choose between two finalists
one with the signal, one without
Shortlist 3 of 6
one applicant with the signal
Withhold a decision
decline to propose a salary
§4.1 (score, choose, shortlist)
§4.4 (withhold)
Q3 With what consequences?
§4.5
§4.6
Remedies fairness instructions
generic EEO prompt; “do not penalize caregiving gaps”
Group outcome signals more common among women (prevalence scenario)